15. Career Pathways and the Future of Low-Code Development

Aim

To study the career pathways that open up through low-code development and the likely future of the technology.

Theory

As more organisations adopt low-code platforms, new and changed roles have appeared. The table lists common pathways and the skills each one needs.

Role	Typical work	Key skills
Citizen developer	Builds small departmental apps for own team	Process knowledge, form and report design
Low-code developer	Builds and maintains business applications on a platform such as Zoho Creator	Data modelling, workflows, Deluge scripting, testing
Automation / integration engineer	Connects apps, APIs and services and automates processes	REST APIs, connections, workflow design
Solutions consultant / architect	Chooses platforms, designs solutions and governs their growth	Architecture, security, governance, stakeholder skills
Pro-code extension developer	Writes services and widgets that extend low-code apps	Node.js / Java / Python, serverless platforms, APIs
Platform administrator	Manages users, environments, deployment and security	Roles and permissions, release management, monitoring

Future of low-code

- Wider use of AI to generate and review applications, with the developer verifying the result.
- Stronger governance, audit and DevOps support for large organisations.
- Hybrid development, where low-code handles the common parts and pro-code the special parts.
- Growing demand for people who can judge where low-code ends and pro-code begins.

Procedure

1. Study the job roles that use low-code platforms.
2. List the skills each role needs.
3. Relate the roles to the skills practised in this course: data modelling, forms, reports, Deluge, workflows, permissions, testing and deployment.
4. Study the expected future trends of low-code.

Result

The study shows that low-code opens pathways from citizen developer to low-code developer, integration engineer, consultant and administrator, and that the future lies in AI-assisted, governed and hybrid development. The skills practised in this course map directly to these roles.